

Agent Skills

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First, a demo

`jira` skill — work with Jira in natural language.

| "Summarize 0A-28145"

What is a skill?

A skill is a markdown playbook the agent can discover and follow.

```
---  
name: skill-name  
description: A description of what this skill does and when to use it.  
---
```

Step-by-step instructions

1. Do the first thing
2. Then do the next thing

Examples of inputs and outputs

Input: "Help me investigate this issue"

Output: Summary, likely cause, next actions

Common edge cases

- Missing credentials
- Ambiguous user request
- Required config not set

Skills can be discovered or invoked

Usually, you describe the task and let the agent choose.

You: "Find production errors for 0A-27793"

Agent: *reads* `opensearch` → searches logs and summarizes findings

If you want, you can also call the same skill directly.

You: `/opensearch Find production errors for 0A-27793`"

Agent: *runs* `opensearch` *directly* → searches logs and summarizes findings

Skills in OpenApply

Local setup

`oa-setup` — get OpenApply running on a new machine.

PM and QA now run OpenApply locally — no engineer needed.

QA verify

`oa-qa-verify` — verify a parent-facing form end to end.

- Opens the form in `agent-browser` and captures an initial screenshot
- Fills required fields with realistic fake data
- Moves through each step, handling dynamic widgets and validation
- Produces a Markdown report with screenshots and issues found

Dev lifecycle

`oa-commit-work` — craft commits with meaningful context

`oa-review-changes` — self-review before opening a PR

`oa-pr-create` — PR with correct template and Jira link

`oa-review-pr` — structured peer review

`oa-demo-update` — delegate complex demo updates to the agent so demo servers get refreshed more often

`oa-release-notify` — stakeholder notification on deploy

Document early

`write-docs` — generate documentation from code and context.

Best run immediately after finishing a feature.

| "Document how reenrollment works."

The agent reads the code, understands the intent, writes the docs.

Why it works

"Many 'non-coding' tasks become tractable once they look like files, programs, tools, and outputs. That gives you leverage from the model's strongest priors instead of fighting them."

— Armin Ronacher, [Leaning In to Find Out](#), 2026

Skills certainty

Files → Read · Write · Edit

Programs → `python3 -c "import json; print(json.dumps(results))"`
`bash -c 'grep ERROR production.log | tail -20'`

Tools → `gh pr create --title "Fix login"`
`curl "$API/issues/OA-123" | jq '.fields.summary'`
`acli jira workitem view OA-123`

Outputs → `## Summary`
`- Root cause: null check missing in reenrollment`
`- Fix: OA-28145, deployed to staging`

if `gh` works in your terminal, it works in the skill.

Writing a skill

The skill specification

Agent Skills support a simple directory structure:

```
skill-name/  
├── SKILL.md           # Required: metadata + instructions  
├── scripts/          # Optional: executable code  
├── references/        # Optional: documentation  
├── assets/           # Optional: templates, resources  
└── ...               # Any additional files or directories
```

In `SKILL.md`, you can point to supporting files directly:

See [the reference guide](references/REFERENCE.md) for details.

Run the extraction script:
`scripts/extract.py`

<https://agentskills.io/specification>

Write a skill manually

Directory structure

```
opensearch/  
├── SKILL.md  
└── references/  
    ├── fetch.md  
    ├── debug.md  
    └── schema.md
```

SKILL.md

```
---  
name: opensearch  
description: >  
  Query production logs. Use when investigating a bug,  
  analysing slow requests, or debugging a Jira ticket.  
---  
# ...
```

Write a skill with the agent

Claude Web — enable then use

1. Customize → Skills → enable `skill-creator`
2. `/skill-creator`

Claude Code — install then use

1. `npx skills add anthropic/skills -s skill-creator -a claude-code -g`
2. `/skill-creator`

Other built-ins

- Codex — `$skill creator`
- VS Code — `/create-skill`

Install skills

Manually — copy the directory, or use `vercel-labs/skills` :

```
~/ .claude/skills/opensearch/SKILL.md  
npx skills add eduvo/agent-skills -s jira -a claude-code -g  
npx skills add eduvo/agent-skills -s opensearch -a claude-code -g
```

Ask your agent — just tell it to install a skill for you.

"install the skill:

<https://github.com/anthropics/skills/tree/main/skills/frontend-design>"

Skills improve over time

Every failure is a gap in the spec.

When a skill misfires: run `skill-creator eval` → find the gaps → improve.

| A skill is never finished. It's a living document.

What's next

Write your expertise into skills

We all have workflows and tricks that took a while to figure out.

- Things you debug in a way others don't know yet
- Shortcuts that took you months to discover

Write them as skills — so others don't have to figure them out the hard way.

Share common skills across teams

Upskill the whole team quickly.

Multiply productivity — not just yours, but everyone's.

A shared repo is the source of truth — [eduvo/agent-skills](https://github.com/eduvo/agent-skills)

Q & A